

City grants to Prague's 57 districts and party alignment

A premium in the city's in-year grants to Prague districts whose mayor's party joins the city coalition is not supported and underpowered: the test could detect about 100 %, against 19–47 % found elsewhere.

SMALLEST PREMIUM THE DESIGN COULD DETECT	at 80 % power · simulated before any grant was added up	≈ 100 %
CHANGE ON BECOMING ALIGNED, H1	of controls' usual grants · 95 % CI -115 to +21 % · p = 0.70	-37 %
THE SAME, PER RESIDENT	CZK a year · 95 % CI -8 800 to +1 800	-2 800
DISTRICTS THAT BECAME ALIGNED	7 in 2018, 23 in 2023 · administrative count	30

OVERWHELMED? HERE'S THE SHORT VERSION

- The negative pooled estimate comes from the 2023 coalition change. After the 2018 change, districts that turned aligned received about a fifth more over three years, and the equivalence test is inconclusive, so a modest premium is not ruled out.
- The sign rests on a few districts. Leaving out those with ODS mayors, the party that entered the coalition in 2023, turns the estimate to about +14 %, and dropping one control district, Troja, brings it to about 0 %.
- The analysis plan was committed before the results, on the author's own branch. Three corrections to the grant data followed the first results; each is listed below with the estimate before and after.
- Two coalition changes cannot separate alignment from anything else the switching districts shared, and the grant lists miss what the city builds in a district itself.
- Outside the test, the thirteen large districts spend 8 346 to 17 604 crowns a year per resident, Praha 1 spends 35 320, and transfers are 76 % of the median district's income.

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status	research, registered analysis plan (self-timestamped)
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data	MONITOR, Ministry of Finance, district reports 2015–2025, accessed 28 September 2026; ČSÚ residents by district 1991–2025, accessed 28 September 2026; the city's closing accounts, part III, 2014–2025, and approved budgets, praha.eu, accessed 28 September 2026; ČSÚ candidate registers 2014, 2018 and 2022 (2022 register of 28 March 2026). Raw files are not redistributed; their SHA-256 hashes are in prague-districts-files.sha256 . Derived data: districts.json , districts_extended.json , districts_extended_robust.json .
code	tools/praha/ , estimates as published at commit ff0f0ca; rebuild the estimates with <code>uv run --with pandas --with numpy --with openpyxl --with xlrd --with scipy python tools/praha/districts_extended.py</code> (full order under Reproduction).
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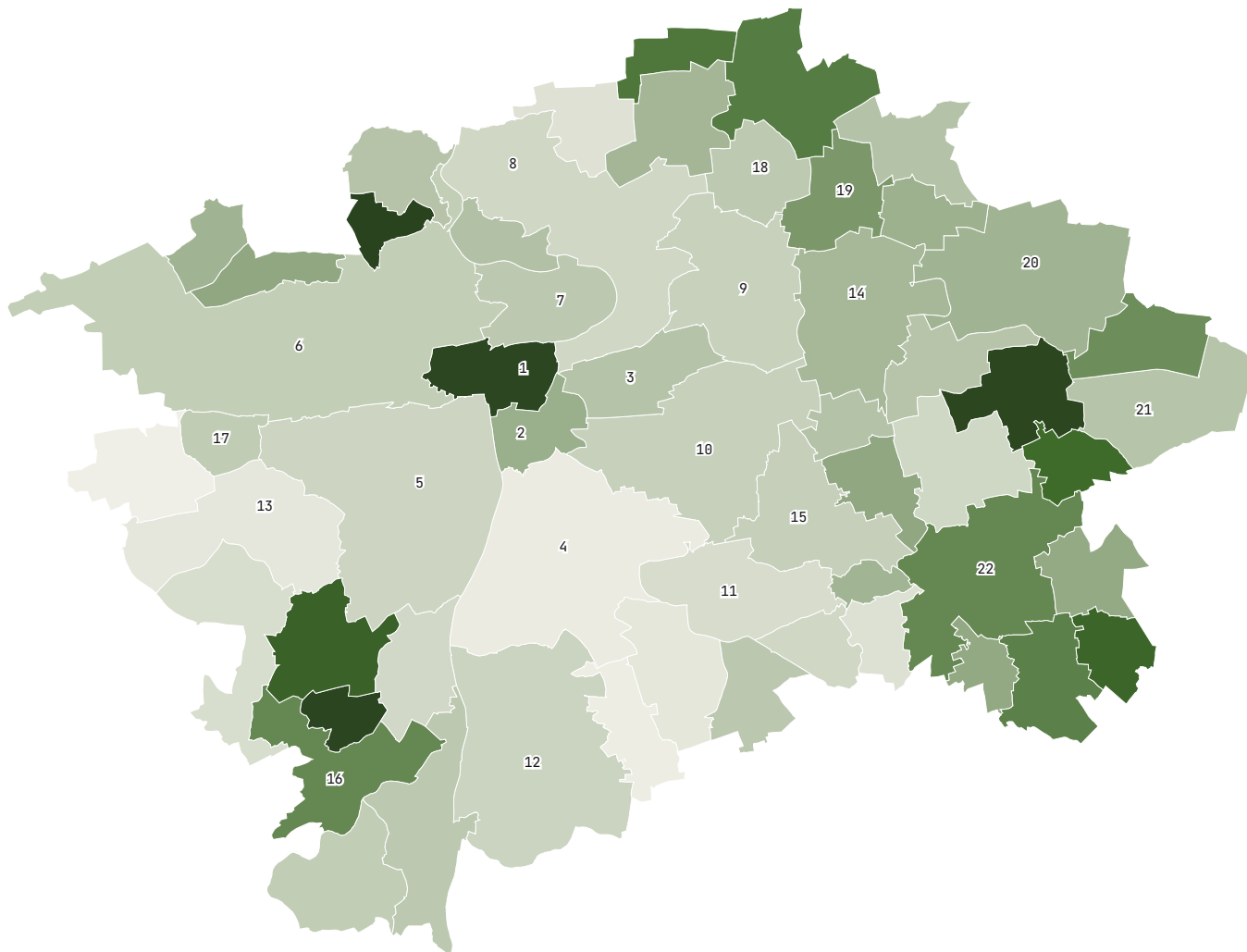
Photo: [Praguegirl15](#) · CC BY-SA 4.0, colour held · Libeň chateau, Praha 8 town hall

The question and what is known elsewhere

Discretionary transfers from a higher tier of government are where studies elsewhere have found an *alignment premium*, meaning that municipalities governed by the same party as the level above receive more. Studies of Spain¹, Brazil² and Italy³ find that aligned municipalities receive roughly a third to a half more (about 40 %, 26–41 % and 36–47 %), a study of Portugal finds 19 %⁴, and in Germany the sign depended on which bloc governed the state, with +25 % under one and –20 to –40 % under the other⁵. Prague is a case these studies do not cover, a capital whose 57 districts elect their own mayors and councils and receive, besides a published formula allocation, grants that the city approves one by one during the year. This part asks whether a district receives more of those in-year grants when its mayor's party joins the city's governing coalition. The power simulation showed before any grant was added up that the design could detect only a premium of about 100 %, two to five times the premiums found elsewhere. The study was run and reported anyway, under rules fixed in advance, so that the Prague result enters the record with its power stated whatever its sign.

Data

Prague runs on two levels. The city keeps public transport, the main roads and the city police, while its 57 districts, from Praha 4 with 135 712 residents to Praha-Nedvězí with 381, run most primary schools and kindergartens, local streets, green spaces and part of social services. Each district reports its accounts to the Ministry of Finance, which publishes them in MONITOR⁶. The ministry's bulk extract leaves the Prague districts out, so the district figures come from MONITOR's public interface, which serves the same reports, and money a district moves into its budget from its own funds (items 4131, 4132 and 4140) counts as its own revenue. Averaged over 2022–2024 and divided by residents at the end of each year⁷, the thirteen large districts, home to three Praguers in four, spend between 8 346 and 17 604 crowns a year per resident, and the small districts on the edge spread from about 8 000 to 35 000, their figures driven by single projects. Transfers from the city and the state are between 38 and 92 % of a district's income, and Praha 1 and Praha 2 are the only districts where they are less than half.



7 000 CZK  36 000 CZK+ · spent per resident · a year, 2022-24

Praha 1-22 numbered.

map · Prague's 57 city districts: spent per resident, CZK a year, and income from transfers, both 2022-2024 (MONITOR, accessed 28 September 2026; residents from ČSÚ); the city's own in-year grants per resident, CZK a year, mean of 2015-2023 (the city's closing accounts, part III); and whether the mayor belonged to, or was nominated by, a party of the city coalition, on 30 June 2015, 2019 and 2023, one date for each term. Praha-Lysolaje, at 73 020 spent and 35 786 in grants per resident, is off both scales. Numbers mark Praha 1-22; boundaries from RÚIAN. Pick a view above the map, and hover or tap a district for all its values.

The table lists every district with the list that won the most seats in the 2022 district election⁸, which is not always the mayor's list, because a coalition of smaller lists can govern. Clicking a heading sorts the table, and the buttons pick large or small districts. In the thirteen large districts the town hall itself, meaning administration, the council and the office, takes a median 29 % of spending (24 to 38 %), education, above all kindergartens and primary schools, 32 % (18 to 42 %), social services 7.5 % (2 to 17 %) and investment of every kind 28 % (14 to 48 %). These shares compare how districts keep their books as much as what they spend on, since the same service can sit in different sections of different districts' accounts.

District	Residents	Per resident ↓	Town hall	Education	Social	Investment	From transfers	Largest list, 2022
Praha-Lysolaje	1 639	73 020	7 %	14 %	0 %	73 %	59 %	Nezávislí - Lysolaje 6 of 9
Praha-Lochkov	837	35 540	14 %	71 %	0 %	68 %	82 %	„Sdružení Lochkov 2022“ 9 of 9
Praha 1	28 921	35 320	35 %	16 %	6 %	13 %	38 %	PRAHA 1 SOBĚ 7 of 27
Praha-Běchovice	2 670	35 025	15 %	23 %	3 %	61 %	72 %	SPOLEČNĚ pro Běchovice 15 of 15
Praha-Slivenec	3 981	28 857	10 %	32 %	0 %	72 %	86 %	STAROSTOVÉ A NEZÁVISLÍ 8 of 11
Praha-Nedvězí	381	27 539	33 %	0 %	0 %	48 %	84 %	Sdružení nezávislých kandidátů Nedvězí 5 of 5
Praha-Koloděje	1 738	26 345	22 %	14 %	0 %	59 %	85 %	Naděje pro Koloděje 5 of 7
Praha-Březiněves	2 164	24 807	25 %	17 %	9 %	40 %	64 %	OBČANÉ PRO BŘEZINĚVES - sdružení pro výstavbu ZŠ, Centra služeb a silničního obchvatu Březiněvsi 7 of 9
Praha-Čakovice	12 589	24 189	15 %	37 %	0 %	64 %	82 %	Společně pro Čakovice 10 of 21
Praha-Kolovraty	4 069	23 585	20 %	43 %	2 %	54 %	87 %	NAŠE KOLOVRATY 12 of 15
Praha 22	15 257	22 731	30 %	41 %	3 %	47 %	78 %	STAROSTOVÉ A NEZÁVISLÍ 6 of 25
Praha 16	8 766	22 714	31 %	16 %	8 %	26 %	76 %	Občanská demokratická strana 10 of 15
Praha-Klánovice	3 854	21 916	12 %	15 %	1 %	57 %	88 %	KLIDNÉ KLÁNOVICE 22 5 of 15
Praha 19	7 909	20 514	42 %	24 %	1 %	27 %	72 %	Sdružení nezávislých kandidátů Kbely náš domov 10 of 15
Praha-Nebuše	2 872	18 578	13 %	25 %	17 %	34 %	81 %	STAROSTOVÉ A NEZÁVISLÍ 9 of 11
Praha-Dolní Měcholupy	4 418	18 548	24 %	24 %	9 %	56 %	69 %	Občanská demokratická strana 7 of 15
Praha-Benice	765	18 377	73 %	0 %	0 %	59 %	69 %	BENICE – MÍSTO PRO SPOKOJENÝ ŽIVOT 7 of 7
Praha-Královice	467	18 173	68 %	0 %	0 %	52 %	87 %	SDRUŽENÍ NAŠE KRÁLOVICE 2022

District	Residents	Per resident ↓	Town hall	Education	Social	Investment	From transfers	Largest list, 2022
								5 of 5
Praha 2	51 388	17 604	26 %	23 %	14 %	28 %	45 %	ODS a TOP 09 - SPOLEČNĚ PRO Prahu 2 14 of 35
Praha-Satalice	2 715	17 374	17 %	23 %	12 %	48 %	82 %	STAROSTOVÉ A NEZÁVISLÍ 6 of 11
Praha 20	17 535	17 032	38 %	17 %	1 %	27 %	72 %	Hnutí Občanů Počernic, PRO Počernice a NEZÁVISLÍ 7 of 25
Praha-Přední Kopanina	698	17 029	36 %	0 %	3 %	46 %	73 %	ZA KOPANINU KRÁSNĚJŠÍ S PODPOROU STAN 9 of 9
Praha-Petrovice	6 040	16 953	17 %	23 %	40 %	53 %	80 %	STAROSTOVÉ A NEZÁVISLÍ 5 of 15
Praha-Ďáblice	4 270	16 603	18 %	21 %	1 %	46 %	77 %	ŽIVÉ ĎÁBLICE S PODPOROU STAROSTŮ 7 of 15
Praha 14	50 525	16 353	24 %	25 %	17 %	48 %	62 %	ODS SPOLU S NEZÁVISLÝMI KANDIDÁTY 7 of 31
Praha-Troja	1 603	15 062	36 %	30 %	0 %	29 %	81 %	TROJSKÝ KŮŇ 2022 7 of 9
Praha-Štěrboholy	2 689	14 740	26 %	34 %	0 %	34 %	67 %	Občanská demokratická strana 9 of 9
Praha-Vinoř	4 604	14 726	39 %	25 %	1 %	41 %	82 %	SDRUŽENÍ PRO VINOŘ 8 of 15
Praha 3	82 149	14 669	27 %	18 %	9 %	41 %	53 %	TOP 09 + Starostové a nezávislí s podporou Žižkov (nejen) sobě 11 of 35
Praha-Suchbát	7 058	14 570	24 %	18 %	3 %	39 %	74 %	SDRUŽENÍ OBČANŮ SUCHDOLA (SOS) 12 of 15
Praha 21	10 988	14 527	45 %	29 %	2 %	26 %	84 %	ODS a TOP 09 - SPOLEČNĚ PRO ÚJEZD 11 of 17
Praha-Dolní Počernice	2 970	14 485	24 %	19 %	1 %	20 %	67 %	DOLNÍ 5 of 15
Praha-Šeberov	3 322	13 954	25 %	54 %	0 %	46 %	83 %	PRO LEPŠÍ OBEC A STAN 11 of 15
Praha 7	47 735	13 881	32 %	28 %	12 %	26 %	67 %	PRAHA 7 SOBĚ 18 of 29
Praha-Zbraslav	10 575	13 850	22 %	31 %	2 %	37 %	77 %	Nezávislá Zbraslav 8 of 17
Praha 18	23 728	13 681	36 %	29 %	1 %	33 %	67 %	Zdravé Letňany

District	Residents	Per resident ↓	Town hall	Education	Social	Investment	From transfers	Largest list, 2022
								7 of 23
Praha 17	24 065	13 274	30 %	19 %	7 %	30 %	77 %	Řepští sousedé
Praha-Lipence	3 203	13 120	21 %	45 %	1 %	30 %	85 %	Sdružení pro Lipence
Praha 6	108 577	12 988	29 %	32 %	3 %	28 %	62 %	Koalice ODS a KDU-ČSL
Praha 15	35 991	12 704	35 %	35 %	11 %	26 %	75 %	Patnáctka náš domov – KDU-ČSL, Strana zelených, Naše Obec a nezávislí kandidáti
Praha 10	119 110	12 612	27 %	42 %	10 %	29 %	69 %	Společně pro Prahu 10 - ODS a TOP 09
Praha 9	68 919	12 523	27 %	38 %	2 %	44 %	61 %	SPOLEČNĚ pro DEVÍTKU
Praha 12	59 999	12 021	30 %	38 %	6 %	28 %	77 %	ODS a TOP 09 společně pro Prahu 12
Praha 5	97 109	11 875	33 %	34 %	6 %	32 %	66 %	PRAHA 5 SOBĚ
Praha-Dubeč	4 168	11 554	28 %	27 %	5 %	23 %	92 %	Občanská demokratická strana
Praha-Újezd	3 893	11 513	38 %	21 %	0 %	39 %	79 %	Občanská demokratická strana
Praha 8	112 478	11 467	28 %	37 %	8 %	25 %	67 %	Občanská demokratická strana
Praha-Velká Chuchle	2 867	11 338	34 %	40 %	1 %	10 %	65 %	Lepší Chuchle
Praha 11	78 410	10 667	29 %	27 %	3 %	29 %	76 %	Hnutí pro Prahu 11
Praha-Řeporyje	6 288	10 488	29 %	33 %	0 %	37 %	77 %	Občanská demokratická strana
Praha-Křeslice	1 150	9 954	56 %	6 %	0 %	21 %	73 %	Okolo Křeslic
Praha-Dolní Chabry	5 641	9 885	35 %	35 %	1 %	10 %	74 %	18400.CZ S PODPOROU STAROSTŮ
Praha-Kunratice	10 045	9 039	21 %	24 %	4 %	44 %	72 %	„Hnutí Praha-Kunratice“

District	Residents	Per resident ↓	Town hall	Education	Social	Investment	From transfers	Largest list, 2022
Praha 13	66 604	9 030	37 %	32 %	6 %	16 %	82 %	Občanská demokratická strana 11 of 35
Praha 4	135 712	8 346	38 %	28 %	8 %	14 %	75 %	SPOLEČNĚ ODS a TOP 09 13 of 45
Praha-Libuš	10 894	8 107	34 %	41 %	1 %	18 %	76 %	Spojené síly pro Libuš a Písnici - TOP 09, STAN a nezávislí kandidáti 8 of 17
Praha-Zličín	8 868	7 763	33 %	32 %	1 %	15 %	78 %	Pro Zličín a Sobín 10 of 15

Per resident: CZK spent a year, mean of 2022–2024. Shares are of spending, except "from transfers", which is of income. Residents at the end of 2024. Data: [districts.json](#).

The grants study uses a different source. Part of the money the city sends its districts follows a formula it publishes each December, built from residents, area, pupils, green space and roads. The rest comes during the year as grants for a school roof, a park, a fire brigade or a playground, each approved by the city council or the city assembly and listed, with its resolution and purpose, in part III of the city's closing accounts². The lists for 2014–2025 were downloaded and parsed, 18 311 lines in all, with at least 98 % of the item lines read in every list. The outcome is the city's *own* grants. Money a district pays back to the city is left out, which covers loan repayments, returned grants and transfers, 162 lines and 1.1 billion crowns in 2016–2023, and so are grants the state passes through the city, EU operational programmes and the year-end settlements. Three kinds of money that are not discretionary in the usual sense stay in, as registered: income-tax refunds passed on to districts, 11–28 % a year of the city's own grants in 2016–2023, shares of the gambling levy, 4–10 %, and repayable loans, 1–13 %, together 20–39 % a year.

■ investment ■ non-investment ■ 2015, not split

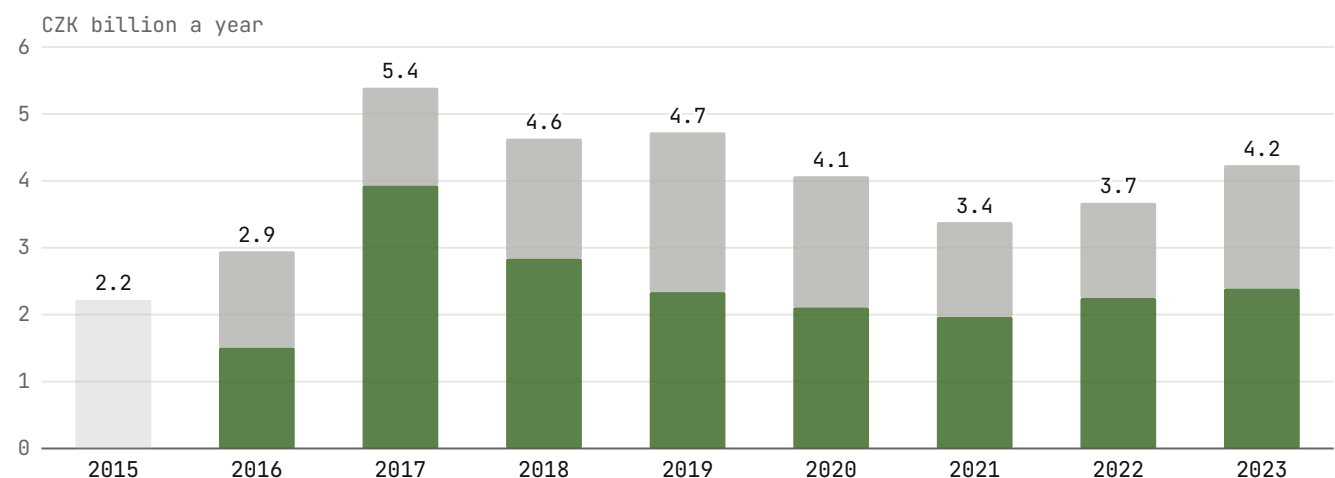


fig. 1 · The city's own in-year grants to all 57 districts by year of the approving resolution, CZK billion; administrative totals, no sampling band. Green: investment; light grey: non-investment. The 2015 list cannot be split. 2018, 2019, 2022 and 2023 are cut at the coalition changes and scaled to a full year. Source: the city's closing accounts, part III, accessed 28 September 2026.

Beyond the formula, the city gives its districts between 2.2 and 5.4 billion crowns a year in this way, and investment is between 49 and 73 % of it (2016–2023). Over all district-years the median is 1.04 times the district's 2016 formula allocation, and in the median district the year-to-year spread is 60 % of its average, since a single school extension can arrive in one year.

How this was done

Each grant is dated by the resolution that approved it, matched by number to the session dates in the roll calls of [Part 1¹⁰](#), and that date decides which coalition the grant belongs to. Grants the outgoing, caretaker council decided in January and February 2023 count for the old coalition. A district's grants are measured against the formula money it received in 2016, so that a small district and a large one can be compared. The rules below were fixed in a design reviewed before modelling¹¹.

A district is *aligned* in a year if its mayor on 30 June belongs to, or was nominated by, a party of the city coalition that day. Every mayor of every district from the 2014 elections to September 2026 was recorded with sources, double-coded by a language model and adjudicated by hand: the two passes named the same mayor for 98.9 % of the 627 district-years, and the seven that differed were settled before any grant was added up. Parties come from the official candidate registers⁸, and a data audit checked about 40 spells against official sources, all of which matched. The coalition changed in November 2018, when the Pirates, Praha Sobě and TOP 09 replaced ANO, ČSSD and the Greens, and in February 2023, when ODS replaced Praha Sobě. A district therefore becomes aligned only when parties change sides at city level, and the study can separate alignment from whatever else happened to one party's districts only as far as two events allow.

At each change, districts that turned aligned and stayed so are compared with districts unaligned throughout, before and after, in a difference-in-differences stacked by event¹². In 2018, 7 districts turned aligned against 31 that stayed unaligned, and in 2023, 23 against 17, a change that made 34 of the 57 districts aligned, up from 14. The effective sample is thus 30 switching districts in two events. The p-values come from randomisation inference, which reshuffles which districts switched within each tier of districts, 9 999 times¹³, and the intervals use a method for comparisons with few treated units¹⁴.

The estimand is the change in a district's grants on becoming aligned, stated in % of the control districts' usual grants, which are their average level in the three years before each change, averaged over the two changes. Because it is a linear difference between two groups divided by that level, its interval can reach below –100 % although no district can receive less than nothing; the same estimate on a per-resident scale is –2 800 crowns a year, with a 95 % interval from –8 800 to +1 800 ($p = 0.67$). A power simulation, run on the real switches before any grant was added up, put the smallest premium detectable at 80 % power at about 100 % of a district's usual grants. The design says in advance that a non-rejection is to be read as "not detected", never as "no premium".

The tests

Hypothesis	Test	Result
H1 · districts that become aligned receive more of the city's own in-year grants	switch-in effect > 0	not supported · underpowered –37 %, 95 % CI –115 to +21 %, $p = 0.70$
H2 · any premium is carried by investment grants	investment effect > 0 and > non-investment	not supported $p = 0.76$

Percentages are of the control districts' usual grants in the years before each change. p-values are one-sided, from randomisation inference; the smallest attainable is 0.0001. Holm thresholds¹⁵ are 0.025 and 0.05, and neither test passes. The equivalence test (is any premium within ± 20 %?) is inconclusive, $p = 0.53$.

Grants after the 2018 and 2023 coalition changes

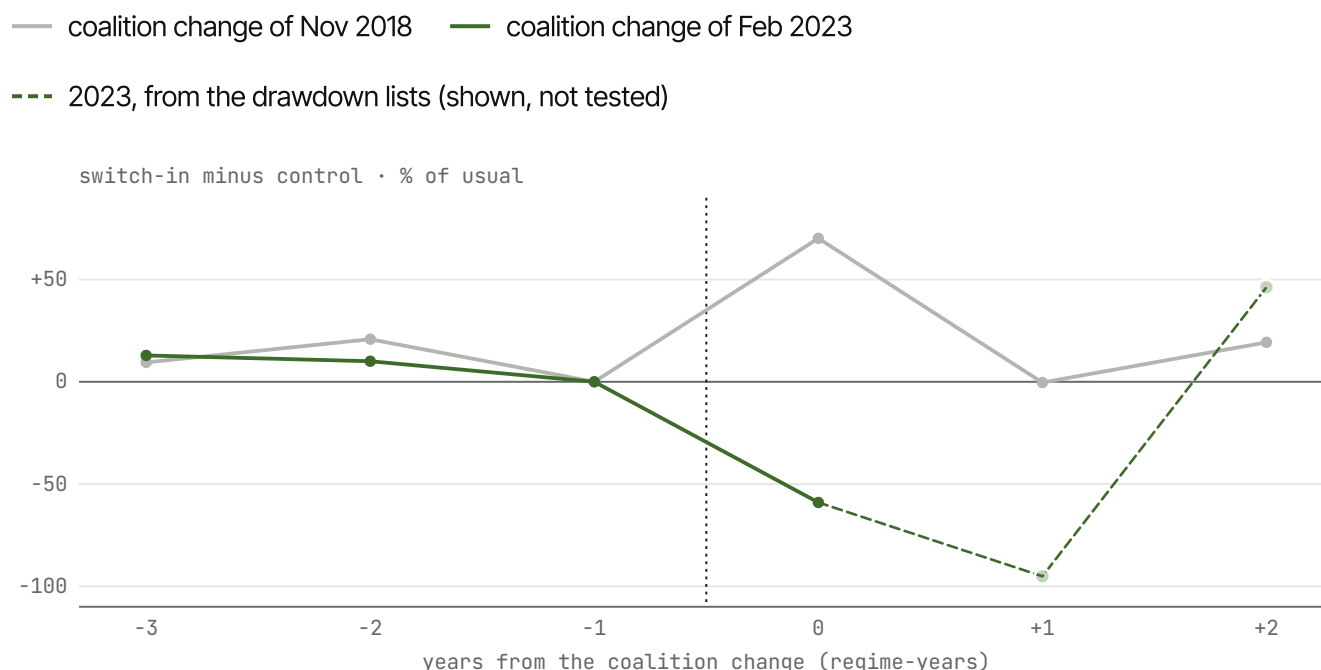


fig. 2 · Districts that became aligned minus districts that stayed unaligned, relative to the last year before each change, in % of each change's control districts' usual grants; point estimates, no band. Light grey: the change of November 2018 (7 against 31 districts); green: the change of February 2023 (23 against 17). Year 0 is the first year under the new coalition. Dashed after 2023: from the city's drawdown lists, which the registered check found too different from the budget-measure lists to join, so those years are shown, not tested. Source: the city's closing accounts, part III, accessed 28 September 2026.

Before each change the two groups moved similarly, and the joint pre-trend test gives $p = 0.97$. After the 2018 change, districts that turned aligned received more in the first year (+70 %) and about the same in the next two, which over the three years, against the three before, comes to +20 %. After the 2023 change they received less, -59 % against 2022 and -67 % against the three years before, and that change is tested on 2023 alone. Pooled, the change on becoming aligned is -37 % of the controls' usual grants, with a 95 % interval from -115 to +21 % (fig. 3), and H1 is not supported ($p = 0.70$).

■ published premiums 26–47 % ■ equivalence margin ± 20 % --- detectable at 80 % power

● 2018 change ● 2023 change

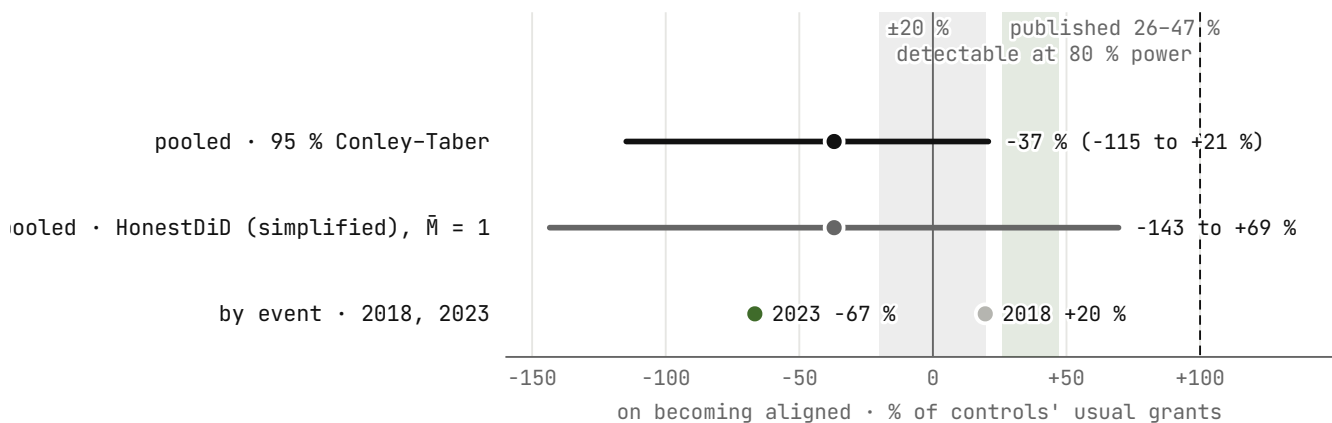


fig. 3 • The registered estimate, in % of the controls' usual grants, with its 95 % Conley-Taber interval (30 switching districts, two events), against the published premiums of Spain, Brazil and Italy (green band, 26–47 %), the equivalence margin (grey band) and what the design could detect (dashed black). The HonestyDiD interval is a simplified version: it lets the trend after each change differ from the trend before by as much as the largest change before it¹⁶. At half that bound the interval is -131 to +57 %.

The equivalence test does not rule out a 20 % premium (upper side $p = 0.11$), nor a large shortfall. Thirty districts had a mayor elected as an ODS member or nominee at some point in 2016–2023, and ODS is the party that entered the coalition in 2023. Leaving all of them out turns the estimate to about +14 %, while leaving out the districts of any other party keeps it negative, between about -35 and -55 %, so the sign depends on the districts of the party that entered in 2023, and this design cannot say whether that reflects alignment or anything else those districts shared. A permutation that pretends other parties had entered the coalition instead places the observed result below 19 of the 20 possible sets ($p = 0.95$).

H2 expected any premium to come as investment, the visible kind of grant. The pooled shortfall is all in investment grants (-39 %), while non-investment grants changed by +2 %, and with no premium to split, H2 is not supported ($p = 0.76$).

Robustness

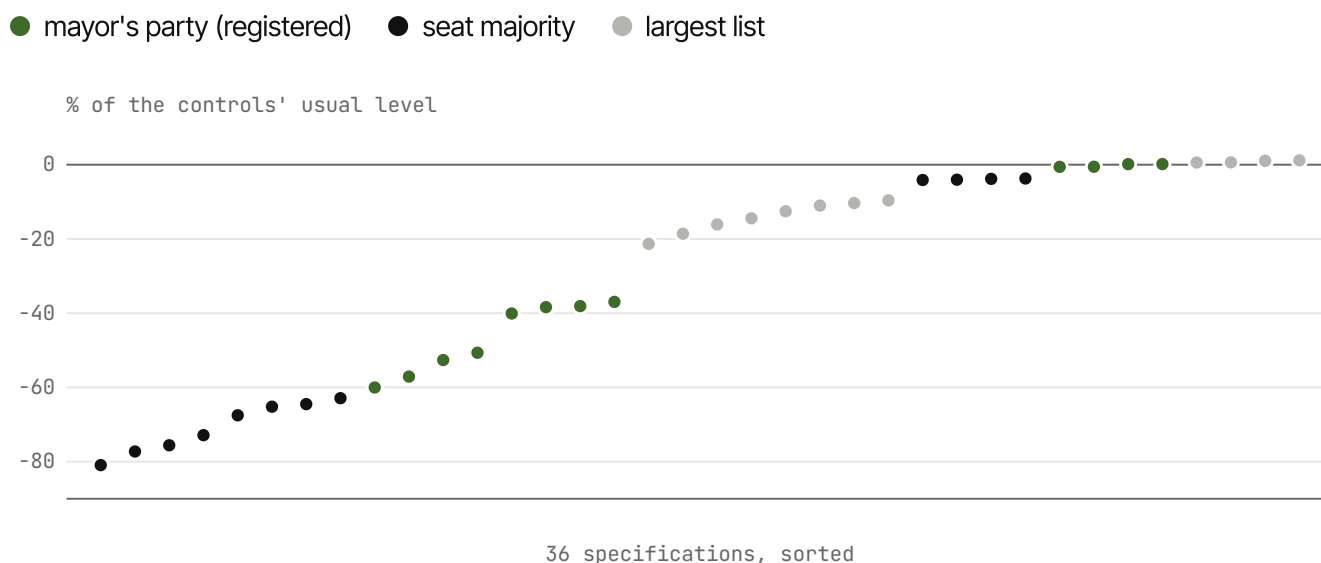


fig. 4 · The same estimate in 36 specifications, in % of the controls' usual level; point estimates, sorted. They combine three scalings (against 2016 formula money, per resident, log), three definitions of alignment, with and without the 2015–16 coalition interregnum, and all districts or without districts under 1 000 residents. Green: the registered alignment rule (mayor's party); black: seat majority; light grey: largest list. Data: districts_extended_robust.json.

Six of the 36 specifications give a positive estimate, and none has a p-value below 0.05, whether from randomisation, the wild cluster bootstrap¹⁷ or small-sample clustered errors^{18,19}. The definition of alignment moves the estimate most, and one control district, Troja, carries much of its negative sign. The table gives the registered checks.

Check	Estimate	Inference
Registered H1	–37 %	95 % CI –115 to +21 %; p = 0.70
Per resident instead of against 2016 formula money	–2 800 CZK a year	95 % CI –8 800 to +1 800; p = 0.67
Without loans, gambling-levy shares and tax refunds	–43 %	
Money districts paid the city counted as negative grants	–36 %	
Alignment from recorded party membership (nominated non-members unaligned)	–36 %	
Alignment by seat majority in the district assembly	–63 %	
Aligned if the largest list includes a coalition party	–10 %	
Regression form of the same comparison	–13 %	clustered p = 0.68; wild bootstrap p = 0.64
Estimator robust to effects that differ between switches ²⁰	–14 %	95 % CI –76 to +32 %
Placebo change, 2020 to 2021	–18 %	p = 0.79
Without the districts with ODS mayors	≈ +14 %	other parties left out: –35 to –55 %
Without Troja (control district)	≈ 0 %	no other district moves it by more than 9 points
Switch-out: 12 districts that left alignment (8 in 2018, 4 in 2023) against those aligned throughout (6 and 10)	–7 %	p = 0.50
District side: unbudgeted in-year transfers in the districts' own reports, 2022–2025 ⁶ , 2023 change	–2 100 CZK per resident a year	p = 0.77; –2 200 adjusted for slower population growth

Percentages are of the control districts' usual grants. Twelve further switches happened mid-term, outside the two changes; they enter only the heterogeneity-robust estimator. Data: districts_extended.json and districts_extended_robust.json.

What changed after registration

When the design was registered, the author had seen the descriptive budget figures of this page's first version, published the day before, and one 2025 grant total for one district, seen while the lists were parsed and outside every test window. The design was registered at 683b0c8 and the first results committed at d8270ac; the changes below followed, all on 29 September 2026, and each is recorded with the runs before and after it in the design file¹¹.

- Choices the design left open were fixed: the denominator of the percentages, the exact form of the equivalence test, a simplified HonestDiD interval, a two-year placebo window, the set of parties in the party-level permutation, and the heterogeneity-robust estimator, implemented directly rather than with its authors' package.
- The test window was cut. The city's lists change format in 2024, and the registered check of the two formats where both exist (2019–2023) found an agreement of 0.72 (0.79 after the corrections below), under the required 0.9, so the 2023 change is tested on 2023 alone. The simulation assumed three years after that change, and the test has one, with 23 switching districts against 17 controls, so power is weaker than simulated.
- The 2023 amounts were corrected. The 2023 list prints its amounts in a column the parser did not read; the fix changed the 2023 total from 25 million to 4.1 billion crowns and moved H1 from +19 % ($p = 0.21$) to –38 %. The error was found because the 2023 total was implausible, not because of the direction of H1.
- Flow direction and dating were corrected (commit 9b3ce92). A data audit found that the parser counted money districts paid the city as grants and dated some approvals to the wrong day of a session held over several days. With both corrected, H1 is –37 %.
- The district-side covariate adjustment was triggered in the first run and not in the corrected one. Its trigger, a population-growth imbalance with p below 0.1, gave $p = 0.098$ with 1 999 draws and $p = 0.11$ with 9 999, and the adjusted estimate is shown either way. An imbalance in the share of children ($p = 0.086$) is not adjusted for, because the registered rule does not name it.
- The first specification curve counted 18 specifications twice (Praha 1 is in neither comparison) and computed the bootstrap and clustered errors for only 18; the curve in fig. 4 has 36 unique specifications, each with all three.
- The literature benchmark was corrected after the results. As registered, it gave Bracco et al. as 10–20 % and compared the power with premiums of 20–40 %; the Bracco figure was wrong, and the comparison is now with roughly a third to a half. The reading of the power, a detectable premium two to three times the published ones, is unchanged.
- Reporting was added for switch-out, the always-aligned districts, the mid-term switches, the smallest attainable p and the HonestDiD interval at half the bound.
- Two parts of the plan were not done: the alignment coding has not been checked against every constituent-session resolution, and four exploratory analyses were not run.

What this means

For a councillor, city official or journalist asking whether the city's in-year grants favoured districts run by its own parties, the results are of two kinds. Measured, from the city's closing accounts, are the grants themselves: between 2.2 and 5.4 billion crowns a year beyond the formula. Inferred, from 30 switching districts in two coalition changes, is the change in a district's grants on becoming aligned: -37% of the controls' usual grants, 95 % CI -115 to $+21\%$ ($p = 0.70$), or $-2\,800$ crowns per resident a year, 95 % CI $-8\,800$ to $+1\,800$. H1 is not supported, and the test is underpowered: the design could detect only a premium of about 100 %. The results neither show a premium nor exclude one: the equivalence test does not rule out a premium of 20 % (upper side $p = 0.11$). Nor do they show that alignment cost districts money. The sign depends on the districts with ODS mayors and on one control district, Troja, so the estimate describes these two coalition changes and cannot be read as an effect of alignment or of any party.

What this does not show

The city's lists record its grants to districts, and they do not record what the city builds in a district itself or through its companies, which is another channel through which a district can benefit. Two coalition changes, with one party's districts at the centre of the second, cannot separate alignment from anything else those districts shared. The design could detect only a very large premium, so a modest one, of the size found elsewhere, may exist and go unseen, and the 2023 change is measured over one year where three were planned. The mayor coding was done twice by the same language model and adjudicated by hand, which is not independent coding; it was checked against the candidate registers and, for about 40 spells, against official sources, but not yet against every constituent-session resolution. The size of the shortfall also depends on the scale. Measured per resident on a log scale, the same comparison gives about 0 %, and against 2016 formula money or per resident in crowns it is negative. No result here says anything about any individual mayor or councillor, and none is a causal effect of a party. Nor does the negative point estimate show that alignment costs a district money, since its interval runs from -115 to $+21\%$, the 2018 change alone points the other way ($+20\%$), and the placebo change from 2020 to 2021, when the coalition did not change at all, gives -18% , a shortfall of a similar order.

Reproduction

The scripts are in `tools/praha/` and run with `uv` on Python 3, each with the packages named in its docstring (pandas, numpy, openpyxl, xlrd, scipy; matplotlib for the figures). Raw downloads are cached in `tools/data/praha3/` and `tools/data/praha3x/` (set `PRAHA3X` to move the second), are not committed, and can be checked against [prague-districts-files.sha256](https://prague-districts-files.s3.amazonaws.com/praha3x/monitor.sha256). MONITOR is read through <https://monitor.statnipokladna.gov.cz/api/>. The [alignment coding](#) is in `docs/research/`. The run order is:

1. `districts.py`: the descriptive budgets, 2022–2024, into `districts.json`
2. `districts_data.py`: MONITOR, ČSÚ and election downloads, 2015–2025
3. `districts_city.py`: the city's closing accounts and approved budgets
4. `districts_grants.py --structure, then --build`: the grant lists into `grants.csv`
5. `districts_alignment.py`: the frozen alignment panel

6. `districts_power.py`: the design-stage power simulation
7. `districts_extended.py`: the registered tests, into `districts_extended.json`
8. `districts_robust.py`: the checks and the specification curve
9. `figures_districts_extended.py`: the static figures

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Change log

- 28 September 2026: first published as "One city, 57 budgets", a descriptive piece on the districts' budgets for 2022–2024.
- 28 September 2026: correction. The first version counted as transfers from the city and the state the money a district moves into its budget from its own funds, mostly business income (items 4131, 4132 and 4140), and gave

transfers as 82 % of the median district's income (66–92 % across the 57), and 23 570 and 7 009 crowns per resident for Praha 1 and Praha 4, saying that even Praha 1 lived mostly on transfers. The figures now exclude them.

- 29 September 2026: the registered study of the city's in-year grants added (version 1 of the long article).
 - 29 September 2026, version 2: retitled from "One city, 57 budgets" to name the question; the deck leads with the underpowered null and gives the published premiums as the body's range, 19–47 %, and the facts no longer lead with the point estimate; the parsing corrections are told once, under What changed after registration; robustness is a table; a per-resident equivalent of the estimate (-2 800 CZK a year, 95 % CI -8 800 to +1 800, from districts_extended_robust.json) and an explanation of the interval below -100 % were added; the mayor coding is described as double-coded by a language model with hand adjudication and listed as a limitation; access dates, the metadata block and a Reproduction section were added; references renumbered; the footer links the series by its current numbering. Removed as descriptive and unregistered: the figures of spending per resident and of income by source, the section on spending shares (its median shares now sit in two sentences under the district table), and the section on budget plans, capital spending and the 2024 formula (their numbers stay in districts.json and districts_extended.json). No published number was corrected.
 - Checked against editorial standard v1 on 29 September 2026.
 - 29 September 2026: added the section What this means.
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